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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Monday, February 23, 2026

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- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rGxFJmgyyV4
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

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[00:19:31] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[00:23:47] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:25:51] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:28:56] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:30:16] The Senate will come to order. The Senators will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery.

[00:30:42] The Senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Daniel M. Sensi from Pohok Episcopal Church in Lorton. And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing.

[00:31:00] We'll be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America by Senate Page Kenley Moser of Norfolk. Let us pray. Almighty and most merciful God, we give you thanks for the blessings that you bestow upon the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[00:31:20] we are grateful for the beauty of the Virginia landscape, our honorable industry, and our rich heritage. By your will, the sons and daughters of this commonwealth were inspired to join in the formation of a great republic founded on the eternal truths of freedom, justice, and equality.

[00:31:40] By your grace, and despite our human depravity, you enable us to march ever onward toward the realization of the godly values that our founders held so dear. I pray especially this day for the men and women of the Virginia Senate, for Governor Spanberger, for Lieutenant Governor Hashmi, and for all elected officials. Guide and bless the Virginia General Assembly to ensure that they may enact such laws as shall please you to the glory of your name. May these individuals who have been

[00:32:14] entrusted with the yoke of leadership, cast aside partisan divides, and work in unity for the benefit of the people of Virginia and to the fulfillment of your purposes. May our laws be just, honorable, and equally applied, and our leaders faithful and trustworthy, serving the people of the commonwealth without reproach.

[00:32:37] And finally, O Lord, we pray that Virginia might always shine as an example of fidelity, truth, mercy, peace, and obedience to you, the divine architect of the universe. We ask all this in your holy name. Amen.

[00:32:53] I pledge of allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:33:17] The clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:33:47] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Friday, February 20, 2026. The senior senator from Henrico moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 33 noes 3 the clerk will report any communications from the House of

[00:34:23] Delegates the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax after madam president good afternoon and present I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 30,

[00:34:57] noes 8. Ayes 30, noes 8. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. We do not have any, Madam President. We've now arrived at the time in our morning hour when we have the privilege of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in our Senate gallery. And I give our my daily reminder about our procedure. A senator will rise and provide the introduction for his or her visitor. I will then

[00:35:33] offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to provide the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The Senator has the floor.

[00:35:50] Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, today doing our morning invocation is the Reverend Daniel Sensi of Pohick Episcopal Church, which is located in my district. Today is the day we traditionally have the reverend who represents the church that was George Washington's church as yesterday would have been his 294th birthday. Madam President, Poick Church was not only the home church of George Washington, it was also the home church of George Mason who, as we all know, was the author of the Virginia Declaration of Rights. It was built in 1774 under the oversight of President Washington. It is a

[00:36:28] National Historic Site, and the recent recipient of a Save National Treasures Grant. Reverend Sensi acquired his BA in Religious Studies from the University of Alabama, his Master's in Divinity from the Virginia Theological Seminary in Alexandria. He's married to his wife Jessica, who's a registered nurse, and together they have two young children, Andrew, Mary, and Emma, and he is here today to send us off.

[00:36:50] So Madam President, I hope you give him the warm welcome to the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and if Reverend and your family will please stand. We would love to recognize each of you. Thank you, Reverend, for providing the blessing and prayer for this morning. And what a fit blessing it is knowing that we are celebrating the birthday of President George Washington. Thank you for your service in such a historic church and such a remarkable community. Welcome to you and to your family.

[00:37:23] delighted to have everyone here today senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to the reverend daniel sensi and his family the chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth thank you madam president madam president in the gallery today rise for an introduction senator president i get so excited when i see my granddaughter i forget what i'm supposed to do

[00:37:58] madam president i rise for the purposes of an introduction the senator has the floor Madam President, in the gallery today we're representatives of the Virginia Governmental Employees Association. VGEA is a volunteer non-partisan advocacy organization that has been representing the interests of current and retired state employees of the Commonwealth for over 65 years. Today public servants from nearly every corner of the Commonwealth came to the Capitol to share their thoughts on how we can improve the lives of the state's 142,000

[00:38:34] employees and appreciation of their tireless service to the commonwealth madam president i hope that it is a pleasure of this body to extend to vga and its members the warm welcome of the senate of virginia thank you senator for that introduction and if our representatives from vga will please stand we are so delighted to welcome you all and to see you all in our senate gallery. We know how indebted the Commonwealth of Virginia is to the work that each of you do in your different capacities all across so many state

[00:39:09] agencies and departments. This is what keeps the ship going, so thank you so much for your dedication, your public service, and all that you do to serve Virginians each and every day. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to the virginia government employees association the chair recognizes the senator from arlington thank you madam thank you madam president i rise for uh two purposes one for

[00:39:47] an announcement in the journal and one for an introduction the senator has the floor i'll start with the announcement for the journal um my seatmate the senior senator from fairfax county is out today on pressing personal business and i'd like the journal to reflect that the journal will so reflect thank you senator thank you madam president next i would like to introduce a group from the foundation for healthy youth uh the foundation for healthy youth as you know was established by the general assembly through a resolution and they have a very active volunteer

[00:40:24] youth group it's called young people from y street and the young people affiliated with the Virginia Foundation for Healthy Youth take on really meaningful projects. They are working to help their peers make healthy choices, choices that in the long run will reduce and prevent tobacco use, substance use, and childhood obesity. These are very active and energetic young people.

[00:40:52] They're excited to be in the General Assembly and I hope the lawmakers welcome them into their offices when they come knocking. I hope it is the will of the Senate to give them a warm welcome. Thank you Senator for that introduction. If our representatives from the Virginia Foundation for Healthy Youth will please stand. Well thank you so much for joining us today in the Senate gallery, but thank you especially for the work that you are doing to ensure that we provide education and information to all of Virginia's youth about healthy habits and healthy living. As we know,

[00:41:28] these have consequences for the rest of our community's lifetime so thank you for this critical work that you are doing senators i ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to the virginia foundation for healthy youth and most especially the young people for y street senators please join me in a warm welcome the chair recognizes the senator from eastern henrico - Thank you, Madam President.

[00:42:02] I rise for an introduction. - The Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. On behalf of Senator Lucas, myself, and members of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority Incorporated, serving throughout the General Assembly, the executive branch, and state governments, I rise today to recognize the 40th anniversary of Delta Days at the Virginia General Assembly, and I'd ask that those participants please stand.

[00:42:27] Madam President, for four decades, the dedicated members of our organization have gathered here during our legislative session, bringing with them not only their voices, but the voices of the communities that they represent. Through Delta Days, they have demonstrated the enduring power of engaged citizenship, reminding us that democracy is strongest when the people participate, advocate, and hold a shared commitment for the public good.

[00:43:00] While year after year women travel from communities all across Virginia, Madam President, this year, due to the snow, they are observing us primarily virtually, but with a powerful, committed delegation here with us today, and they are standing in the gallery.

[00:43:20] so madam president again we mark this 40-year milestone honoring not only the founders and early participants of delta days here at the general assembly but the participants who have sustained that established tradition and the countless others who will well into the future keep this vision moving forward madam president i hope it would be the pleasure of this body to join me in giving them a distinctive senate welcome thank you senator for that introduction

[00:43:52] and i am sorry uh as as the senator stated i i regret that the weather disrupted our plans for such an important celebration we know however we will continue to honor this special day the 40th anniversary of delta days here in the general assembly your work in so many communities is honored and respected.

[00:44:16] Thank you for all that you do, most especially for our young people. And we're so delighted that we have two representatives right here on the Senate floor-- the distinguished senator from Portsmouth, the distinguished senator from Eastern Henrico, and we know that they make you very proud.

[00:44:35] Thank you so much for joining us. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives who are here today for Delta Day.

[00:44:54] The chair recognizes the senator from Franklin County. - Thank you, Madam President. I'd ask that the Senate journal reflect that my seatmate, the senator from Orange, is away from the Capitol today on pressing personal business. - Thank you, Senator.

[00:45:09] The journal will so reflect. Is there any other business for the morning hour? The clerk will call the calendar.

[00:45:26] - Senate calendar for Monday, February 23rd, 2026. Unfinished Business Senate Senate bill 27 the house insists on its substitute and request a committee of conference The senator from Eastern Prince William Thank You madam president madam president asked the Senate to a seat to the house request for a committee of conference on on the bill The question is shall the Senate a seat to the request for a committee of conference on Senate bill

[00:46:01] All in favor of that motion will please record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:46:25] Ayes 29, noes 9. Ayes 29, noes 9. The Senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference. Comfrey's on the part of the Senate. For Senate Bill 27, is named by the chair of the Committee for Courts of Justice, Senator Surville, or Senators Carol Foy, Deeds, and Sturdivant.

[00:46:49] Senate Bill 74. The House insists on its substitute and requests a Committee of Conference. The Senior Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate accede to the House request for a Committee of Conference. The question is, shall the Senate accede to the request for a committee of conference on Senate Bill 74?

[00:47:10] All those in favor of the motion will please record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk

will close the roll.

[00:47:31] Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference. Senate Bill 3, Senate Bill 70, I'm sorry, Senate Bill 373.

[00:47:46] The House insists on its substitute and request a Committee of Conference. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we accede to the Committee of Conference. The question is, shall the Senate accede to the request for a Committee of Conference on Senate Bill 323?

[00:48:06] All those in favor of the motion will please record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role eyes 35 nose 3. eyes 35 nose 3 the senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference conferees on the part of the senate on senate bill 323 is named by the chair of the committee

[00:48:39] for courts of justice senator surveil or senators surveil jones and obenshane senate bill 337 the house insists on its substitute and request a committee of conference the senior senator from loudon thank you madam president madam president i move that we accede to the house request for committee of conference the question is shall the senate accede to the request for a committee of conference on senate bill 337 all those in favor of that motion will please record their votes i

[00:49:11] those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 37 noes zero ayes 37 noes zero the senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference conferees on the part of the senate for senate bill 337 is named by the chair of general laws and technology senator mcpike

[00:49:42] are senators perry mcpike and reeves senate bill 425 the house insists on its substitute and request a committee of conference the senior senator from henrico thank you madam president matter president i move that the uh the senate accede to the house request for a committee of conference the question is shall the senate accede to the request for a committee of conference on Senate Bill 425. All those in favor of the motion will record their votes aye,

[00:50:15] those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference. Comferees on the part of the Senate, excuse me, we don't have conferees yet. Senate Bill 581, the House insists on its substitute and

[00:50:50] request a Committee of Conference. The Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. I move that the Senate accede to the House request for a Committee of Conference on the bill. The question is, shall the Senate accede to the request for a Committee of Conference on Senate Bill 581? All those in favor of the motion will please record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 38 no zero eyes

[00:51:28] 38 knows zero the Senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference conference have not yet been named Senate bill 589 the house insists on its substitute and request a committee of conference the senator from central Fairfax thank you madam president I move that the Senate accede to the house request for a committee of conference the question is shall the Senate accede to the request for a committee of conference on Senate bill 589 all those in favor of the motion will please record their votes aye those opposed no

[00:52:02] are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate accedes to the request for a committee of conference. Uncontested calendar, House bills on third reading. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the House bills on third reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 7 through 16, House Bill 73 through 1347,

[00:52:42] be advanced or final passage in the block after the adoption of amendments there to any senator desiring move bill for the block please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill the question is shell house bills on the uncontested calendar third reading pages 7 through 16 House bill 73 through House bill 1347 be placed upon their final passage in a block after the adoption of any amendments thereto with the understanding that any senator desiring a bill be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor

[00:53:17] of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. House Bill 73 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 100 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House As Bill 116 reported from the Committee on Education and Health.

[00:53:45] As Bill 123 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. As Bill 156 reported from the Committee on Education and Health. As Bill 191 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments.

[00:54:01] The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the Committee of Amendments. The question is, shall the Committee Amendment from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:54:17] The ayes have it. The committee amendment is agreed to. House Bill 249, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 276, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments. The senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[00:54:33] Move the committee amendments. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. As bill 332, reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute.

[00:54:53] The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:55:08] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 342, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 350, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 399, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology.

[00:55:26] House Bill 423, reported from the Committee on Education and Health. House Bill 584, reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute. The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to.

[00:55:43] the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to has bill

671 reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendment the senator from eastern fairfax with the committee amendment the question is shall the amendment from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed No, the ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to. House Bill 705, reported from the Committee

[00:56:21] on Education and Health with a substitute. The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 712, reported from committee on education and health has bill 870 reported from the committee on general laws and technology has bill 970 reported from the committee on education and health has bill 1020 reported

[00:56:58] from the committee for courts of justice has bill 1036 reported from the committee on education and health has bill 1039 reported from the committee on education and health has bill 1117 reported from the committee on general laws and technology has bill 1119 reported from the committee for courts of justice has bill 1157 reported from the committee on general laws and technology

[00:57:29] has bill 1176 reported from the committee on general laws and technology has bill 1247 reported from the committee on general laws and technology has bill 1254 reported from the committee on General Laws and Technology. House Bill 1278 reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute. The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in

[00:58:04] favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 1289 reported from the Committee on General laws and technology. As bill 1308, reported from the committee on general laws and technology. As bill 1311, reported from the committee on general laws and technology. As bill 1347, reported from the committee on education and health with a substitute. The senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move

[00:58:43] that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Question is, shall the House bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on

[00:59:16] their third reading be passed by for the day? My apologies. The question is, shall the House bills on the uncontested calendar on their third reading now be passed? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:59:51] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes zero. Ayes 38, noes zero. The bills in the block pass. Regular calendar has bills on third reading, has bill six relating on relating to contraception, right to contraception, Applicability enforcement reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute.

[01:00:24] The senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye.

[01:00:40] Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Madam President, I move that the bill pass. and speaking to that most senator has the floor uh thank you madam president what this

bill does is it establishes the right to contraception it prohibits any infringement from the commonwealth or any locality on this policy does create a cause of action against uh any uh anybody who infringes on such rights of course if they're with the commonwealth or a locality um and we did add a line the uh senate substitute added a line noting that parental consent would still be

[01:01:18] required as it is our current law with that explanation i again move that the bill pass the question is shall house bill six pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, Nose 15. Ayes 23, Nose 15. House

[01:01:57] Bill 6 passes. House Bill 43, a bill relating to abolishing the common law crime of suicide. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill pass and speak to that bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, House Bill 43 is a bill that abolishes the common law crime of suicide. There's actually still a few common law crimes that are still out there, and these are crimes that basically are not even stated on the code books, but they existed

[01:02:34] at common law when we came over from England and have not been repealed by the General Assembly. Common law trespass, for example, is still out there. This is basically a bill that we've seen several times. I think Doug and Rob Krupeka used to originally carry it, and Doug and Simon's picked up that work. The bill has a delayed effective date of July 1 of 2027, and it also directs the Bureau of Insurance to do a study into whether or not there's any effect or implication of abolishing this crime so that if there is a problem, we can take action before next year. I doubt there is a problem. This has been bouncing around now for at least seven or eight, nine years now. Obviously,

[01:03:13] nobody's ever really charged with suicide because that's not really possible. So the effects, if anything, would probably be on the civil side. And so I would hope we could pass it. It's really kind of an overdue action by us. And the fact that it remains in the books just has more to do with folks not being comfortable taking action. But I think the time has come, and I hope we could pass it. The question is, shall House Bill 43 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes

[01:03:47] aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, no 16. Ayes 22, no 16. House Bill bill 43 passes has bill 125 a bill relating to public elementary and secondary schools teachers terms of employment reemployment of teacher who has not received continuing contract status written notice required reported

[01:04:26] from the committee on education and health with a substitute the senator from Arlington madam president I move that the substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the substitute is agreed to senator from arlington madam president i move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor thank you what this bill does is it makes a tweak in our statute requiring teachers to give written notice if they choose to not continue their

[01:05:04] contract the written notice must be done by june 15th of each year i hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill. The question is, shall House Bill 125 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 27, noes 11. Ayes 27, noes 11. House

[01:05:44] bill 125 passes has bill 165 a bill relating to board for contractors examinations alternative languages reported from the committee on general laws and technology with an amendment the senate senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president I move that the amendments be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on general laws and technology be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed

[01:06:21] no the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to senator from Prince William thank you madam president move that the bill passed and speaking to the motion the senator has the floor thank you very much madam president so this bill provides that any exam offered by the board of contractors that averages over 50 50 administrations over the preceding four years be also provided in languages pursuant to our Virginia voting rights action in section under 24.2, I believe it is, and move the bill's passage.

[01:06:59] The question is, shall House Bill 165 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:07:17] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 7. Ayes 31, noes 7, House Bill 165 passes. House Bill 182, a bill relating to high school graduation requirements, history and social studies credits, certain substitutions permitted.

[01:07:39] Reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute. The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to?

[01:07:54] all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Arlington madam president I move that the bill passed and speaking to the motion the senator has the floor thank you what this bill does is it requires the board of education to allow students to substitute the african-american history course for the world history or or World Geography course to satisfy the History or Social Service Studies credit.

[01:08:26] It also clarifies, however, that a student, if they want to receive the credit towards graduation, must actually complete an assessment for the course. I hope it is the will of the body to pass this bill. The question is, shall House Bill 182 pass?

[01:08:44] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Of all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 16.

[01:09:03] Ayes 22, noes 16, House Bill 182 passes. House Bill 201, a bill relating to school board policies, parental notification, safe storage of prescription drugs, and firearms in the household.

[01:09:19] Reporting from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute. The Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[01:09:35] Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the bill pass. And speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you. What this bill does is it requires each school board to have a policy that will require annual notification on safety securing prescription drugs and firearms and this notification of course would go to the parents of

each student the bill also requires that this notification be available in multiple languages on the school website as well and it clarifies that certain information and statistics

[01:10:14] required of the bill for notification can be found from the Centers for Disease Control or another nationally recognized organization I do hope it is will of the body to pass this bill the question is shall house bill 201 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll

[01:10:47] Ayes 20. Noes 18. Ayes 20. Noes 18. House Bill 201 passes. House Bill 221. A bill relating to requirements for appeals bond indigent parties appeal of unlawful detainer. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass and speak to the motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:11:18] Ladies and gentlemen, Senate, this bill has to do with appeal bonds when somebody appeals an unlawful detainer, which most people know is an eviction to a circuit court. Usually when you appeal a case from general district court to circuit court, in order to what you call perfect the appeal, you have to post a bond in the amount of the cash represented in the judgment.

[01:11:40] That's waived if somebody is, that can be waived if a court finds that somebody is indigent as is defined in the, for purposes of court appointed counsel. However, there currently is an exception for that for unlawful detainer cases. So in eviction cases, you cannot waive the appeal bond.

[01:11:55] This undoes that. We initially had some concern about this, but what alleviated that concern is that even though the indigent person being evicted does not have to post the appeal bond, they do have to continue paying their rent through the trial and circuit court so the landlord would still keep getting their rent if they don't think to file a motion to have the eviction expedited.

[01:12:17] so we were fairly comfortable with this after it came through i would ask that we pass the bill the question is shall house bill 221 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 20 no 17. ayes 20 no 17 house bill 221

[01:12:51] passes. Madam President. Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, how do you vote on the prevailing side by which we just passed HB 221? Motion to reconsider that vote so a member may cast a vote. The question is, shall the vote by which House Bill 221 was passed be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators

[01:13:24] desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, no 0. Ayes 38, no 0. The motion is agreed to. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. I haven't been previously explained, I move the bill to pass. The question is, shall House Bill 221 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no.

[01:13:53] So are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, no 17. Ayes 21, no 17.

[01:14:09] House Bill 221 passes. House Bill 346, a bill relating to Virginia Freedom of Information Act, extensions to application of chapter public utility account numbers reported from the Committee on

General Laws and Technology.

[01:14:25] senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill pass and speaking to the motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 346 provides under the existing FOIA exemption for financial institutions as any account number routing information or any credit card, debit card, or other account information with a financial institution it adds or public utility to that FOIA exemption. Madam President, that's what bill does and move its passage the question is shall house bill 346 pass all in favor of that

[01:15:01] motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role eyes 37 Nose 1. Ayes 37. Nose 1. House bill 346 passes. House bill 347. A bill relating to military and emergency laws local emergency management plans reported from the committee on general laws and technology. The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you madam president move the bill pass and

[01:15:40] speaking to the motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you. The this changes the from every four years to every five years the frequency which every local or inter-jurisdictional agency has to review and update its emergency operation plan and move its passage the question is shall house bill 347 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote

[01:16:09] the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero eyes 38 no zero house bill 347 passes house bill 357 a bill relating to release of accused on secured or unsecured bond reported from the committee for courts of justice the senator from eastern fairfax thank you madam president move the bill passes speaking to that the senator has the floor thank you madam president house bill 357 uh has to do with bond conditions this is a bill we saw a similar bill we saw last year which passed here on a party line vote and got vetoed the bill basically says that it removes the condition

[01:16:49] that anybody who's arrested for a felony who's been previously convicted of a felony we're currently on bond on unrelated arrest in neighboring jurisdiction or on probation or parole can only be released on a secured bond bill also adds factors the judicial officer shall consider making bail determination such as their current bond status for an unrelated arrest or whether the person's on probation or parole again we passed this bill last year or something very close to it And I hope we could pass it again.

[01:17:21] The question is, shall House Bill 357 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:17:37] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 18. Ayes 20, noes 18. House Bill 357 passes. -Post Bill 373, a bill relating to restaurants' food allergy awareness notice required, reported from the Committee on Education and Health.

[01:18:00] -The Senator from Arlington. -Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the bill pass, and speaking to that motion. -The Senator has the floor. -Thank you. This bill requires the State Health Commissioner to publish in multiple languages notices on the Department of Health website regarding procedures for food allergies for restaurant staff um and this uh these notices must also be posted inside restaurants and have another post with translations to let patrons know who to notify if they

believe they have a food allergy i think this is a good public health measure and i hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill

[01:18:39] the question is shall house bill 373 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes Those opposed. No. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 15. Ayes 23, noes 15. House Bill 373 passes. House Bill 396, a bill relating to charitable gaming, Texas Hold'em poker tournaments. Reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute.

[01:19:18] the senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president I move the substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on general laws and technology be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Prince William thank you madam president I move the bill passed and speaking to the motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president so this bill with the substitute is now identical to Senate Bill 765 from the senator from Richmond, Senator Jones, dealing with Texas Hold'em tournaments.

[01:19:55] So I appreciate the bill's passage. The question is, shall House Bill 396 pass? All in favor of that motion? Will record their votes aye? Those opposed no? Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 15. Ayes 23, noes 15. House Bill 396 passes. House Bill 459, a bill relating to crime victims' right to non-disclosure of certain

[01:20:32] information, hate crimes. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the bill to pass and speak of that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, current Virginia law says that whenever a crime victim is a victim of sexual assault, sexual abuse, or family abuse, their identity cannot be disclosed. For example, somebody sends a Freedom of Information Act request. This adds to that the victim of a hate crime. It does allow that the victim of hate crime's identity can be released to the extent the disclosure is required by law or necessary for law enforcement purposes

[01:21:10] are permitted by the courts for good cause shown or if the next of kin, if it's a minor or the person provides written consent. But that's basically what the, it also prevents, by the way, at the request of the victim, if there's any appellate decisions on the case, if it goes up the chain, up to the court appeals, the Supreme Court, that the victim's identity is not revealed in the written opinion that the court issues.

[01:21:34] We considered the bill, given the things that hate crime victims might face, if their identity is revealed, we thought it was a good idea. We'd hope we could pass the bill. the question is shall house bill 459 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero ayes 38 no zero house

[01:22:05] bill 459 passes has bill 567 a bill relating to court records aggregated case data request by attorney for the Commonwealth exempted reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the bill to pass and speak of that motion. Senator has the floor. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, this bill has to do with Commonwealth attorneys requesting aggregated case data, which basically isn't allowed right now. This basically says they can request it and the Supreme Court

has to provide it upon request. I guess Commonwealth attorneys sometimes like to see that for different reasons for doing their job. The bill passed the

[01:22:44] courts of justice committee 12 to 1. I would hope we could pass the bill. The question is, shall house bill 567 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, no zero. Ayes 38, no zero. House bill 567 passes.

[01:23:15] House Bill 595, a bill relating to Board of Education requirements for graduation with an advanced studies diploma, simultaneous completion of international baccalaureate diploma, an advanced studies diploma, approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements, reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute.

[01:23:46] The Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye I'm sorry all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Arlington madam president I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president this bill will allow students who transfer into a

[01:24:22] Virginia public high school after 10th grade and are pursuing both an advanced studies diploma and an international baccalaureate diploma to use the international baccalaureate courses to meet certain state graduation requirements including history and economics it also requires the Board of Ed to grant a waiver for the CPR and first aid graduation requirement for students who cannot complete the training due to an IEP they're on an individual education Education plan or a 504 plan or who transfer from a school that did not require it

[01:24:57] There is a final enactment clause directing the Board of Education to amend its regulations in accordance with the provisions of this bill I hope it is the will of the body to pass this bill. Thank you The question is shall House bill 595 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes. I those opposed No. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 17. Ayes 21,

[01:25:32] noes 17. House Bill 595 passes. House Bill 601, a bill relating to exemptions from garnishment, minimum protected account balance, certain benefit payments, procedure for financial institutions. Reported from the committee for courts of justice. The Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of House Bill 601 and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, this is the same as my Senate Bill 301 about garnishments. It protects a minimum balance of a thousand dollars and makes automatic protections that already exist

[01:26:08] under law so that people don't have to go to court. This was a party-line vote so everybody pay attention. However, in the House we won 30 member Republican votes. that's 83% I'm not asking for 83% I just love three so if the senator from Lynchburg Franklin Hanover want to vote for this very fine bill that would be appreciated but once again I renew my call for passage the question is shall house bill 601 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do

[01:26:47] any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 18. Ayes 20, noes 18. House Bill 601 passes. House Bill 644, a bill relating to Virginia Freedom of Information Act, exemption for records of minors participating in certain programs run by state public bodies. Reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology. The Senior Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speak into the motion.

[01:27:21] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is a recommendation of the Virginia Freedom of Information Advisory Council. It simply exempts from the mandatory disclosure requirements of FOIA, the actual personnel contact information of minors who are participating in programs such as internships, apprenticeships, and fellowships. So that is the bill and appreciates this passage.

[01:27:46] the question is shall house bill 644 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 36 noes 2 ayes 36 noes 2 house bill 644 passes house bill 680 a bill relating to forensic science board scientific

[01:28:23] advisory committee members service after expiration of term emergency reported from the committee on general laws and technology the senator from prince william thank you madam president uh move the bill pass and speaking to the motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president uh what it does is updates the forensic science board's advisory committee location from the city of richmond to its new facility just outside richmond so it strikes Richmond as its official meeting location and move its passage.

[01:28:58] The question is, shall House Bill 680 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:29:14] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. House Bill 680 passes. House Bill 803.

[01:29:30] a bill relating to repairs or maintenance of property entering adjoining property petition for entry reported from the committee for courts of justice the senator from western henrico thank you madam president madam president i move passage house bill 803 and speaking to that the senator has the floor thank you madam president this is identical um to my senate bill 77 which passed the senate 34 to 5 and if you remember this has been workshop for a couple years around getting access to a zero lot line home to make repairs so i move passage the question is shall house bill 803

[01:30:08] pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, no 6. Ayes 31, no 6. House Bill 803 passes. House Bill 933, a bill relating to penalties for failure to appear contempt reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a

[01:30:42] substitute. The Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you so much, Madam President. Move the committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Henrico thank you so much madam president house bill 933 from what motion madam president I move that we move the move the bill forward in speaking to that motion senator has

[01:31:18] the floor thank you so much madam president Senate House Bill 933 is the cognate to senate bill 283 and just as a reminder to the body this legislation has been stripped down to just defining the willful language fails to appear to allow for the courts to be able to take into consideration mitigating circumstances as to why an individual may have missed their original court date so i hope we can move this legislation forward the question is shall house House Bill 933 pass, all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[01:31:56] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 18.

[01:32:11] Ayes 20, noes 18, House Bill 933 passes. House Bill 1147, a bill relating to Board of Nursing continuing education requirements, Reported from the Committee on Education and Health with the substitute.

[01:32:32] The senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:32:48] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. What this bill does is directs the boards of medicine and the boards of nursing to require licensees to complete learning activities on biased reduction.

[01:33:10] And the bill also identifies or permits that certain coursework in certain areas of healthcare delivery be identified. That's the content of the bill. I think it's much needed. I hope it is the will of the body to pass it.

[01:33:26] The question is, shall House Bill 1147 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote?

[01:33:44] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 29, Noes 9. Ayes 29, Noes 9, House Bill 1147 passes. bill 1437 a bill relating to teacher other instructional personnel and support staff position exits data collection disengagement by race reported from the committee on education and health the senator from Arlington madam president I move that the bill passed and speaking to the motion senator has the floor thank you madam president this bill would require each school board to

[01:34:21] annually report personnel and staff exits the end the reasons why and the bill also requires that such information be disaggregated by race we think this is a much-needed bill especially when we're worried about recruitment and retention in our school system I hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill the question is shall House bill 1437 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote?

[01:34:56] Of all the Senators voted, do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 17. Ayes 21, noes 17. House bill 1437 passes. House bill 1499, a bill relating to instructional material that contains sexually explicit content applicability construction reported from the committee on education and health the senator from arlington thank you madam president madam president i move that the bill pass and speaking

[01:35:32] to that motion senator has the floor thank you this bill clarifies that the definition of instructional material is material that is assigned by a teacher to study or complete does not include library books unless it is specifically required by a teacher It does add a provision to clarify that nothing in the bill shall be misconstrued to allow censoring of books or used as a rationale for the removal of books. I do hope it is the will of the body to pass this piece of legislation. The question is, shall House Bill 1499

[01:36:10] pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 18. Ayes 20, noes 18. House bill 1499 passes.

[01:36:33] Uncontested calendar, house bills on second reading. The senator from eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the house bills on secondary and the uncontested regular calendars, pages 20 through 35, house bill 225 to 1405, that the rules be suspended in the second constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the second reading of the titles of the house bills on the uncontested and regular calendars

[01:37:05] pages 24 through 35 house bill 225 through house bill 1405 be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll as 37 noes zero. Ayes 37, noes zero. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern

[01:37:44] Fairfax. Madam President, I ask that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the house bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their third reading go by for the day? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the clerk. Does that complete today's calendar. Yes, sir. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The

[01:38:20] senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies gentlemen of the Senate, although I'm really tempted to have a long dialogue with the clerk about the virtues of curling, in light of her fascination from Friday I rise to talk about the guy in our rotunda down here President General George Washington having yesterday been his 294th birthday I'm fortunate as you

[01:38:56] know to represent his home in Fairfax County and I always like to just talk on his day on the things we can learn from his life here in the Senate you know we We often talk about political capital in terms of votes, polling numbers, other things that we all keep track of.

[01:39:15] George Washington was a leader who he understood different kind of math when it came to political capital. He viewed character as the only hard currency that elected officials have in this business. He also knew that if he was going to lead and build a system that was based on the consent of the governed, that people aren't only consenting to your policies, but they also are consenting to your integrity as an elected official if the public stops believing you as a person they eventually stop believing the institution itself so it's very important we all keep that in mind as we conduct ourselves last year I talked

[01:39:52] about his actions at Newburgh if you all recall at Newburgh up in New York many of his officers were very upset about the fact that we're getting paid and they had a meeting to talk about having a mutiny and March on Congress to conduct basically a martial law sort of military takeover of governments they get themselves paid and General Washington at that meeting walked into the meeting and basically pulled

some his they call him his spectacles glasses out of his pocket and told them that he had basically grown blind in his service of the country in that war and that moment by revealing his frailty caused his

[01:40:31] officers to basically recommit themselves to the idea of a civilian governed military in honor of the shared sacrifice that he had gone through with them as their leader and he had built because he had built himself a reservoir of trust amongst the people he served with through that shared sacrifice so the lesson from that is clear trust is demanded by our office it's not just demanded by our office it is earned in the trenches of shared service that's That's what I think a lot of folks in the military understand.

[01:41:06] He also had a legendary temper, but he's also remembered for his stoicism. The few people who are left who served with Senator Poehler, my predecessor, would recall that she often left copies of George Washington's 110 Rules of Civility that he had to transcribe repeatedly as a child.

[01:41:30] Senator Poehler would leave them here for everybody in the Senate to make sure they read them. He also understood that civility is the oil that keeps the gears of democracy churning along and prevents them from grinding to a halt. I think we in this chamber appreciate that, as I've noticed in the 10 years I've served here, we tend to be a little more civil to each other than down the hall.

[01:41:51] But that's also a practice that we live by in the state senate. And General Washington, he treated his cabinet like in a civil manner, which included, by by the way, at the time, bitter rivals like Hamilton and Jefferson, who actually served in his cabinet, people who eventually were on the opposite sides of the political parties in the forum.

[01:42:14] If you recall, in the Hamilton play, some of Jefferson and Hamilton's battles are recorded in what they called Cabinet Battle I and Cabinet Battle II, at the conclusion of which Thomas Jefferson told Hamilton where he was going to put his shoe.

[01:42:35] And then Jefferson reminded him that Hamilton wasn't getting what he wanted because you don't have the votes, you don't have the votes. And to recall at the end of that, George Washington told the two of them to go outside and pulled Hamilton aside and told him to go outside and figure out a compromise because he was going to have to figure out something.

[01:42:56] He treated the people in his cabinet and people in deep conflict with civility because he understood that when we treat an opponent as an enemy of the state, we also degrade the state itself. Not everybody in this state agrees on how it ought to be governed. We're obviously on, some of us in here are on different sides of things. But to Washington, restraint and the failure to use power was not a sign of weakness. It was the ultimate proof of a leader's fitness to govern. So just think about that. You don't always have to punish or use your power in order to show people how powerful you are. And his greatest act, which I also talked about

[01:43:34] two years ago, was itself in leaving the stage. He often won by retreating, or at the very end, surrendering power. By stepping down after two terms, he proved the American experiment was about the office and not about the man. He created that precedent, that he wasn't going to be a king.

[01:43:52] So for those of us in this room today, the challenge here to us today is the same. Are we all of us, each of us, building that reservoir of trust that can survive an unpopular but necessary decision? All of us are going to have to make that choice sooner or later in this place it's inevitable are we treating our reputations as a private asset or a public trust think about that do we have the courage to be the adult in the room when political winds demand a firebrand because that's often something that we have to

consider think about how he handled that some madam president Washington's legacy is and it tells us that policies are written in ink but the

[01:44:29] foundation of our country is written in trust please remember that and please Please remember that trust, folks, is built in drips, but it's lost in buckets. Think about that. Like General Washington, let all of us strive to leave the bucket of public trust full for each of us and for this chamber fuller than when we found it.

[01:44:52] I hope those are things we can think about today, the day after George Washington's 294th birthday. Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the Senator from Shenandoah.

[01:45:09] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an announcement. has the floor thank you madam president this uh thursday virginia farm bureau is celebrating their 100 year anniversary and would love to extend the invitation to all you all in appreciation they are going to offer us a bus that will leave the parking garage and there's going to be an email sent to everyone around five and we'll bring you back about 6 45 and i know like me many of you all value uh what virginia farm bureau brings in representing that culture and forestry industry

[01:45:45] in this state and they would love to have all of us as their guests at their home office on rich creek so i just wanted to offer that announcement thank you senator the chair recognizes the senator from colonial heights thank you madam president rise for an announcement senator has the floor uh madam president uh members of the senate tonight is the house versus senate basketball game and uh the team is team is looking good that's right just like uh usa took out canada yesterday morning it's uh same same match up tonight um we're not canada uh the uh governor's uh team

[01:46:23] plays the lobbyists at 7 p.m and then we play right after that so if everybody who is playing or watching but especially if you're playing please get there at 7 p.m vcu this evening so so we can get warmed up. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:46:39] - Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Prince William. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, rise for a point of personal privilege. - Senator has the floor. - All right, thank you, Madam President. Madam President, before I ran for office, I was a newspaper reporter for 10 and a half years, and I spent nine years, two months, and two weeks at that time, over at the Gainesville Times, Prince William Times, and Prince William, covering a lot of things, including when you're in a two-person newspaper, I was also the entirety of the sports department for the people who were fully assigned to Prince William County.

[01:47:10] So I got to cover Battlefield High School at Haymarket from the time where right after it opened in '04 from when I started there in '06. I got to cover their first state title in 2010 when they won the football championship. And at the same time, I covered their gymnastics teams for years, years, years, and they had so many talented people.

[01:47:26] And at the same time, they always were striving to try to get a state title. And well, they finally got it this past weekend win a very, very close match over at Kellum High School in Virginia Beach, where they competed against Robinson from Fairfax, who was the runner up.

[01:47:43] And Battlefield won with 147.95 to 147.65. Both teams won two of the four events there. Battlefield just nicked them out. So congratulations to our Bobcats back in Haymarket. And we have a

second Battlefield celebration as well, As we had Battlefield, another one of their student-athletes, Alyssa Sagal, set a national record in swimming this past weekend as well.

[01:48:16] As she was closing out her high school career in the way that she does, she's a University of Virginia commit and she won the state title. She capped her individual portion of her high school career according to Inside NOVA by setting a new national record in the 100-yard backstroke, so sorry, the phone froze here, by winning with a time of 50.56 seconds, eclipsing the mark of 51.46 set by former Olympian Olivia Somiga in 2012. Early in the meet, she also won the 50 freestyle and quick, though not quite record-breaking fashion, at 23.04

[01:48:52] seconds, so congratulations to her. And then finally, Madam President, unrelated to athletic accomplishments want to talk about one other thing that does involve our schools including battlefield on last week last Friday a number of students all throughout Prince William County took a walkout and they did it briefly they stayed on campuses and none of them ended up having major disciplinary issues or any of them aware of that came out of it and they were standing up because they were tired of seeing basically ice raids against people who they knew against in their families against in greater prince william and greater manassas specifically

[01:49:28] and you know i hear some comments sometimes it talks about why do students do you know such things why why walk out why why this why that i wanted to just remind the body and remind everyone that we have two statues representing virginia in statutory hall in congress one of them's george washington we were hearing about earlier and the other is barbara johns barbara johns who famously led a student walkout to protest unfair conditions at her school, first in an all-white school down the street.

[01:49:57] And her case was later rolled into Board v. Brown Education, which led to desegregation of schools. And when we have her as one of our two representatives at Statutory Hall, it is a reminder about the importance of student voices and how much student voices matter student activism matters and that students it's not that you do it frequently it's not that you do it disruptively but when they do speak up and speak out as an entire collective an entire unit in this

[01:50:33] they capture people's attention to the causes that are so important to them And so for my student constituents and others who are involving themselves in the civic process who are making sure their voices are heard and are making sure that they are safe and that they are coordinating and that they're doing everything by the book while at the same time speaking up for the people who are really scared in their communities right now, I just want to say keep speaking up and keep knowing that your voice matters, especially here in the Commonwealth of Virginia, where we have a long legacy of students.

[01:51:08] student-led activism that has led to change. Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico. Madam President, I rise for a point of personal privilege. Senator has the floor.

[01:51:25] Madam President, over the weekend, a devastating tragedy occurred here in our commonwealth, right here in Richmond. And today, I rise to uplift the life of Genesis Jones of Petersburg. Madam President, as a human being first, And then as a mom, when I heard about this tragedy, the details didn't matter.

[01:51:49] The circumstances didn't matter. What mattered was that today there are families in my communities who are carrying the unbearable pain of knowing they would never see their loved ones

again.

[01:52:04] Madam President, Genesis Jones, the daughter of Tangie Jones and Markel Jones, was a 23-year-old young woman whose life did not deserve to be cut short by gun violence. Genesis was more than a headline.

[01:52:20] She was a daughter, a friend, a member of her community. She was 23 years old, an age filled with ambition, possibility, and the promise of a future still unfolding. Her dreams, her contributions, and the life she was building was taken far too soon.

[01:52:40] Her oldest brother, Madam President, shared with me that Genesis had a way of making you feel comfortable being around her. She was herself at all times and full of energy and laughter. She could effortlessly make you laugh.

[01:52:57] She had a lot of potential and was finally coming into herself as a young woman. But now she's been robbed of that. My sister had an impact on so many. Madam President, I rise today not only to mourn her loss, but to recognize the profound impact that loss has had on her loved ones and on the broader community that I represent.

[01:53:23] Madam President, no family should have to endure the pain of losing a child to violence, and no community should grow accustomed to the grief that arrives with such devastating regularity. Jenis' name deserves to be spoken in this chamber, and she deserves to be remembered with dignity.

[01:53:44] Madam President, her memory calls on us to reflect the value of every life, on the safety of our neighborhoods, and on our responsibility as leaders to work to ensure that we fight for a commonwealth where young people, and all people, quite frankly, can pursue their futures without fear. Madam President, today I extend my deepest condolences to Genesis family and friends, and to every family that was affected by this senseless act of violence. Thank you. Thank you, Senator. Is there any other business to come before the

[01:54:24] Senate? The clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Comfries on the part of the Senate on Senate Bill 74 is named by the Chairman of Local Government, Senator Aird, or Senators McPike, Aird, and Hackworth. Comfries on the part of the Senate for Senate Bill 425. Comfries on the part of the Senate as named by the Chairman of Local Government, Senator Aird, are Senators Bagby, Aird, and Stanley.

[01:55:01] Comfrey's on the part of the Senate for Senate Bill 581 as named by the Chair of Local Government, Senator Aird, are Senators Saleem, Prakarski, and Diggs. Comfrey's on the part of the Senate on Senate Bill 589 as named by the Chair of Local Government, Aird are Senators Salim, Senevasen, and Suterland. Today, Monday, February 23rd, the Committee on Commerce and Labor will meet 15 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room A, GAB. The Northern

[01:55:38] Virginia Delegation Caucus will meet at 5 p.m. in House Room 1000, 10th Floor, GAB. Tomorrow, Tuesday, February the 24th, 2026, the Committee on Finance and Appropriations will meet at 9 a.m.

[01:55:53] in Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol. The Republican Caucus will meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. There's no

snow in the forecast, but there is a big possibility of a lot of black ice, so please be careful this evening. Go Senate. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth. Thank

[01:56:33] you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow. The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned

[01:56:51] until 12 noon tomorrow. Senate chamber, be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on

[01:58:09] past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube

[01:58:14] channel, the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

